PRACTICAL 6 - SPATIO TEMPORAL MODELS AND MODEL COMPARISON

Aim of this practical:

In this practical we are going to look at space-time model and model comparison and validation techniques.

You can download the R-script of this practical by clicking the button below:

0 Space time models

0 Space-time modelling

Libraries to load:

```
library(dplyr)
library(INLA)
library(inlabru)
library(sf)
library(terra)
library(fmesher)

# load some libraries to generate nice map plots
library(scico)
library(ggplot2)
library(patchwork)
library(mapview)
library(tidyterra)
```

0.2.1 The data

In this practical, we will revisit the data on the Pacific Cod (*Gadus macrocephalus*) from a trawl survey in Queen Charlotte Sound. The `pcod` dataset is available from the `sdmTMB` package and contains the presence/absence records of the Pacific Cod during each surveys along with the biomass density of Pacific cod in the area swept (kg/Km^2). The `qcs_grid` data contain the depth values stored as 2×2 km grid for Queen Charlotte Sound.

The dataset contains presence/absence data from 2003 to 2017. To make computations faster we only consider the first 3 years.

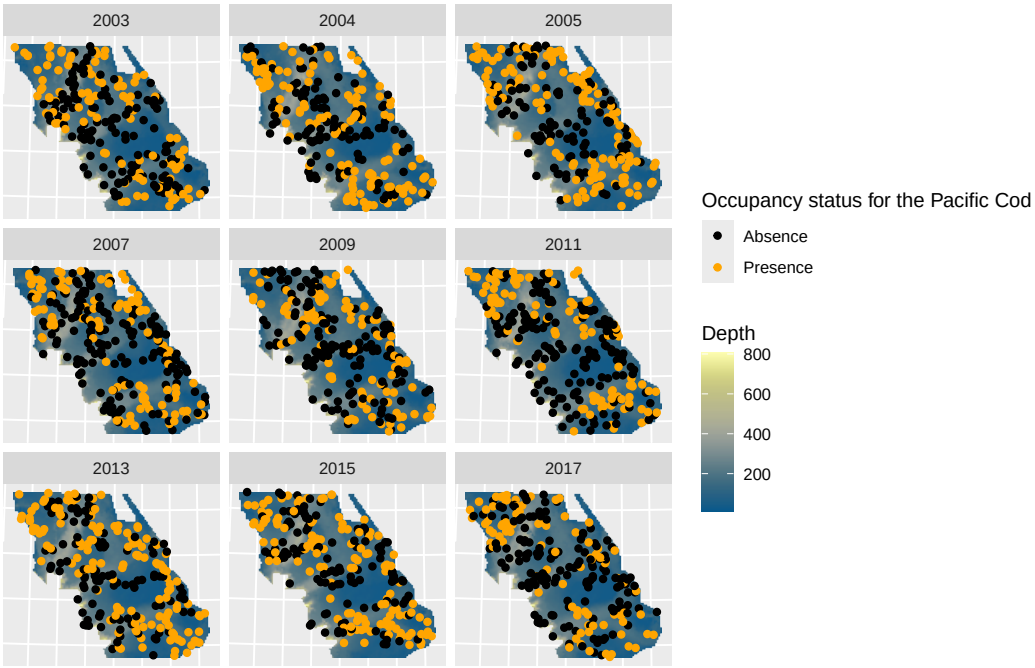
```
load(here::here("datasets/pcod.RData"))
```

Then, we create a `sf` object and assign the right coordinate reference to it:

```
pcod_sf =   st_as_sf(pcod_df, coords = c("lon","lat"), crs = 4326)
pcod_sf = st_transform(pcod_sf,
          crs = "+proj=utm +zone=9 +datum=WGS84 +no_defs +type=crs +units=km" )
```

We convert the covariates into a raster and assign the same coordinate reference:

```
depth_r <- rast(qcs_grid, type = "xyz")
crs(depth_r) <- crs(pcod_sf)
```



0.2.2 Spatio-temporal modeling

0.2.2.1 Model fitting Now lets compare two different space-time models using LGOCV and some information criteria metrics. The general model structure is given by:

$$y(s,t)|\eta(s,t) \sim \text{Binom}(1, p(s,t))$$
$$\eta(s,t) = \text{logit}(p(s,t))$$

We also want to compare the models using WAIC, DIC and marginal likelihood:

Task

Set the `bru_options` so that the quantities of interest are computed
Click here to see the solution

```
bru_options_set(control.compute = list(waic = TRUE,dic= TRUE,mlik = TRUE))
```

0.2.2.2 Model 1

1. **Model 1 - time iid effect** We consider a separable space-time model with a linear predictors given by:

$$\eta(s,t) = \beta_0 + f_1(\text{depth}(s)) + f_2(t) + \omega(s)$$

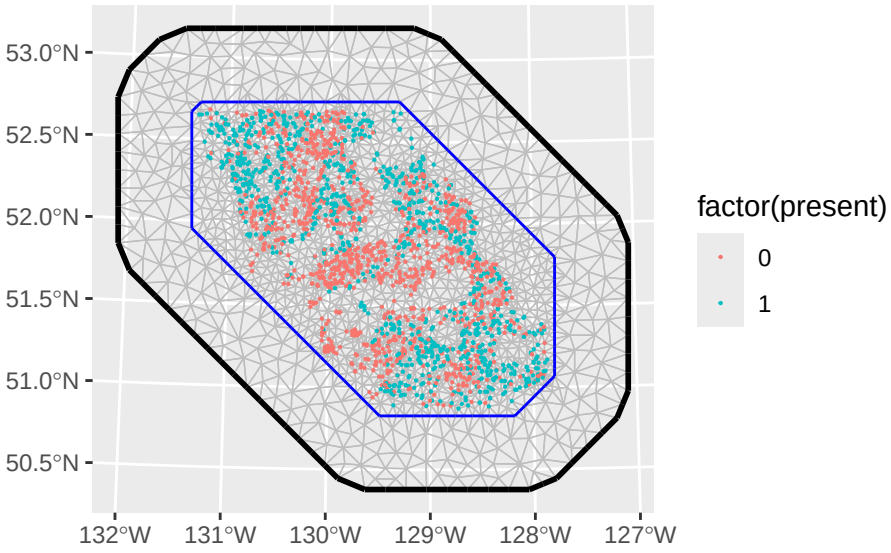
- $f_1(\text{depth}(s))$ is a smooth covariate effect of depth (modeled using a RW2 model)
- $f_2(t)$ is an IID effect of time
- $\omega(s)$ is Matérn random field.

The first step is to define the mesh and the spde model

Construct the mesh and the SPDE model

```
mesh = fm_mesh_2d(loc = pcod_sf,
                  cutoff = 1,
                  max.edge = c(10,20),
                  offset = c(5,50),
                  crs = st_crs(pcod_df))

spde_model =  inla.spde2.pcmatern(mesh,
                                  prior.sigma = c(1, 0.5),
                                  prior.range = c(100, 0.5))
```



create time index and the grouped variable

To use the RW2 model the covariate has to be grouped:

```
depth_r$depth_group = inla.group(values(depth_r$depth_scaled))
```

we also define a time index from 1 to in the data frame

```
pcod_sf = pcod_sf %>%
     mutate(time_idx = match(year, c(2003, 2004, 2005)),
         id = 1:nrow(.)) # Observation id for CV
```

Task

Implement the model in `inlabru`

1. Define the components
2. Define the formula
3. Define the likelihood model using the `bru_obs()` function
4. Run the model

Click here to see the solution

```
# Model components
cmp_spat = ~ Intercept(1) +
  covariate(depth_r$depth_group, model = "rw2", scale.model = TRUE,
            values = sort(unique(values(depth_r$depth_group)))
             )+
  trend(time_idx, model = "iid")+
  space(geometry, model = spde_model)

# Linear predictor
formula_spat = present ~ Intercept  + trend + space + covariate

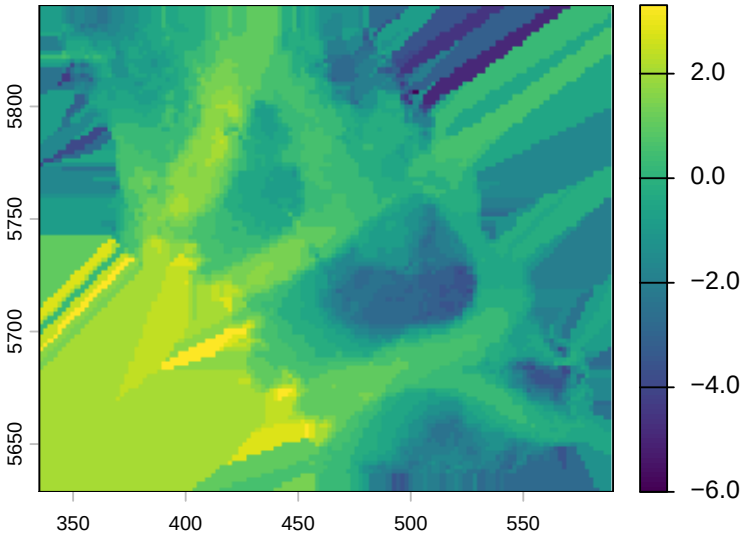
# Observational model
lik_spat = bru_obs(formula = formula_spat,
              data = pcod_sf,
              family = "binomial")

# Fit Model
fit_spat = bru(cmp_spat,lik_spat)
```

Note

Note that there are some survey locations in certain years that fall outside the depth raster region. `inlabru` will input these missing covariate values using the nearest available value. This can be computationally expensive, but you can avoid it by supplying a raster layer that encompasses all of your data points (e.g., by pre-imputing these missing values with your preferred method of choice).
One way of doing this in the `inlabru` framework is to use the `bru_fill_missing()` function:

```
# Select the raster of interest
depth_orig = depth_r$depth_group
re <- extend(depth_orig, ext(depth_orig)*1.05)
# Convert to an sf spatial object
re_df <- re %>% stars::st_as_stars() %>%  st_as_sf(na.rm=F)
# fill in missing values using the original raster
re_df$depth_group =  bru_fill_missing(depth_orig,re_df,re_df$depth_group)
# rasterize
depth_filled <- stars::st_rasterize(re_df) %>% rast()
plot(depth_filled)
```



We have now fit the model and want to check the results.

Task

Is the effect of depth significant? Does it seem important to have a non-linear model?
Inspect the estimated time effect and
Use the `predict` function to inspect the estimated spatial effect.
Use the `depth_r` raster to define the points in space where to predict

```
pxl = st_as_sf(data.frame(crds(depth_r)), coords = c("x","y") ,
               crs  = st_crs(pcod_sf))
```

Click here to see the solution

```
# covariate effect

p_cov = fit_spat$summary.random$covariate %>%
  ggplot() + geom_ribbon(aes(ID, ymin = `0.025quant`, ymax = `0.975quant` )) +
  geom_line(aes(ID,mean)) + ggtitle("Covariate effect")

# time effect
p_time = fit_spat$summary.random$trend %>%
  ggplot() + geom_errorbar(aes(ID, ymin = `0.025quant`, ymax = `0.975quant` )) +
  geom_point(aes(ID,mean)) + ggtitle("Time effect")

#space effect
pred_space = predict(fit_spat, pxl, ~ space)

p_space_mean = ggplot() + gg(pred_space, aes(color = mean))
p_space_sd = ggplot() + gg(pred_space, aes(color = sd))
```

0.2.2.3 Model 2

1. **Model 2 - spatiotemporal field** We consider a separable space time model with a linear predictor given by:

$$\eta(s,t) = \beta_0 + f_1(\text{depth}(s)) + \omega(s,t)$$

- $f_1(\text{depth}(s))$ is a smooth covariate effect of depth (RW2)
- $\omega(s,t)$ is a space-time Matérn spatial field with AR1 time component

$$\omega(s,t) = \phi\,\omega(s,t-1) + \epsilon(s), \qquad \epsilon(s) \sim \text{GF}(\sigma_\epsilon, \rho_\epsilon)$$

Task

Implement this second model in `inlabru`

1. Define the components For the AR1 model use this following PC prior for the correlation parameter ϕ

```
# PC prior for AR(1) correlation parameter
h.spec <- list(rho = list(prior = 'pc.cor0', param = c(0.5, 0.1)))
```

2. Define the formula
3. Define the likelihood model using the `bru_obs()` function
4. Run the model (This model can take a couple of minutes to run)

Click here to see the solution

```
# Model components
cmp_spat_ar1 = ~ Intercept(1) +
  covariate(depth_filled$depth_group, model = "rw2", scale.model = TRUE)+
  space_time(geometry,
        group = time_idx ,
        model = spde_model,
        control.group = list(model = 'ar1',hyper = h.spec))

# Linear predictor
formula_spat_ar1 = present ~ .

# Observational model
lik_spat_ar1 = bru_obs(formula = formula_spat_ar1,
               data = pcod_sf,
               family = "binomial")

# Fit Model
fit_spat_ar1 = bru(cmp_spat_ar1,lik_spat_ar1)
```

Now we want to check the results

Task

What is the estimated parameter phi in the auto-regressive part of the model?
Check the effect of the covariate.
Use the `predict` function to inspect the estimated probability of presence. Use the same prediction points as before, but here you also need to use the '
Click here to see the solution

```
# autoregressive effect

#fit_spat_ar1$summary.hyperpar

#covariate
p_cov_ar1 = fit_spat_ar1$summary.random$covariate %>%
  ggplot() + geom_ribbon(aes(ID, ymin = `0.025quant`, ymax = `0.975quant` )) +
  geom_line(aes(ID,mean)) + ggtitle("Covariate effect")


#space-time effect

inv_logit = function(x){ exp(x) / (1 + exp(x))}

pxl_all = fm_cprod(pxl, data.frame(time_idx = 1:3))
pred_space_ar1 = predict(fit_spat_ar1, pxl_all, ~data.frame(logit_prob = Intercept  +
                                                              covariate  +
                                                              space_time ,
                                                            prob = inv_logit(Intercept  +
                                                              covariate  +
                                                              space_time)))



p_ar1 = pred_space_ar1$prob %>% ggplot() + geom_sf(aes(color = mean)) +
  facet_wrap(.~time_idx) + scale_color_scico(direction = -1) +
  theme_map
```

0.2.3 Model Comparison

Now we want to use the WAIC, DIC and MLIK to compare the models

Task

Compare the scores, what is your conclusion?
Click here to see the solution

```
out= data.frame(Model = c("Model 1", "Model 2"),
  DIC = c(fit_spat$dic$dic, fit_spat_ar1$dic$dic),
  WAIC = c(fit_spat$waic$waic, fit_spat_ar1$waic$waic),
  MLIK = c(fit_spat$mlik[1], fit_spat_ar1$mlik[1]))
```

0 Model check and comparison

0 Model Checking for Linear Models

In this exercise we will:

- Learn about some model assessments techniques available in INLA
- Conduct posterior predictive model checking

Libraries to load:

```
library(dplyr)
library(tidyr)
library(INLA)
library(ggplot2)
library(patchwork)
library(inlabru)
```

Recall a simple linear regression model with Gaussian observations

$$y_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_i, \sigma^2), \qquad i = 1, \ldots, N$$

where σ^2 is the observation error, and the mean parameter μ_i is linked to the linear predictor through an identity function:

$$\eta_i = \mu_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i$$

where x_i is a covariate and β_0, β_1 are parameters to be estimated.

0.4.1 Simulate example data

We simulate data from a simple linear regression model

```
beta = c(2,0.5)
sd_error = 0.1

n = 100
x = rnorm(n)
y = beta[1] + beta[2] * x + rnorm(n, sd = sd_error)

df = data.frame(y = y, x = x)
```

0.4.2 Fitting the linear regression model with `inlabru`

Now we fit a simple linear regression model in `inalbru` by defining (1) the model components, (2) the linear predictor and (3) the likelihood.

```
# Model components
cmp =  ~ -1 + beta_0(1) + beta_1(x, model = "linear")
# Linear predictor
formula = y ~ Intercept + beta_1
# Observational model likelihood
lik =  bru_obs(formula = y ~.,
            family = "gaussian",
            data = df)
# Fit the Model
fit.lm = bru(cmp, lik)
```

0.4.3 Residuals analysis

A common way for model diagnostics in regression analysis is by checking residual plots. In a Bayesian setting residuals can be defined in multiple ways depending on how you account for posterior uncertainty. Here, we will adopt a Bayesian approach by generating samples from the posterior distribution of the model parameters and then draw samples from the residuals defined as:

$$r_i = y_i - x_i^T \beta$$

We can use the `predict` function to achieve this:

```
res_samples <- predict(
  fit.lm,          # the fitted model
  df,              # the original data set
  ~ data.frame(
    res = y-(beta_0 + beta_1)  # compute the residuals
  ),
  n.samples = 1000   # draw 1000 samples
)
```

The resulting data frame contains the posterior draw of the residuals mean for which we can produce some diagnostics plots , e.g.

```
ggplot(res_samples,aes(y=mean,x=1:100))+geom_point() +
ggplot(res_samples,aes(y=mean,x=x))+geom_point()
```

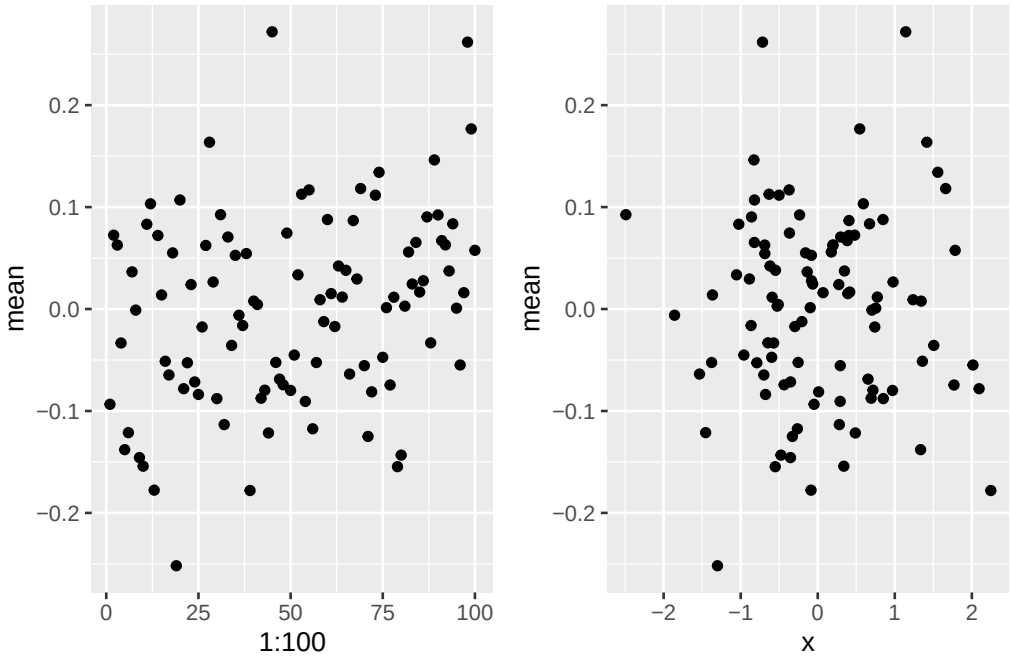
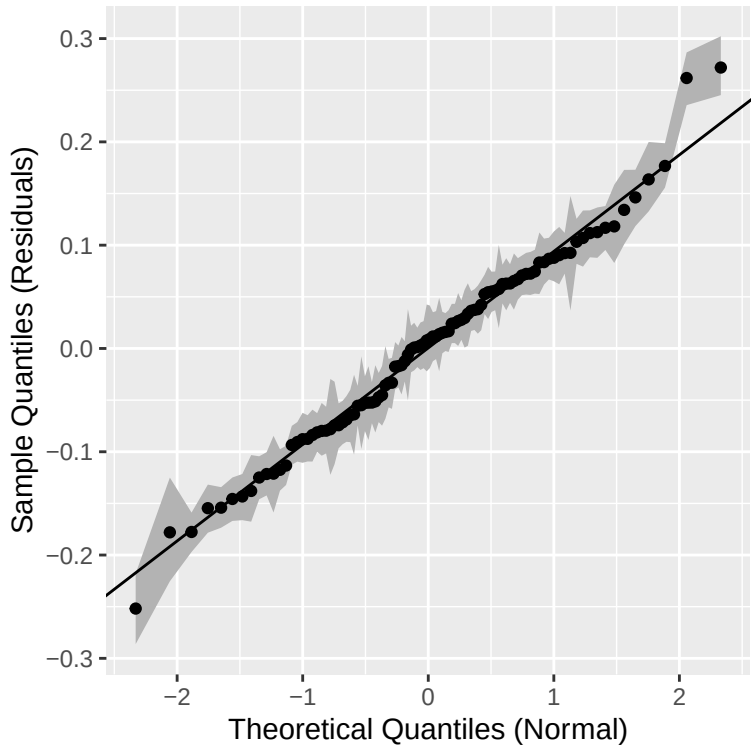


Figure 1: Bayesian residual plots: the left panel is the residual index plot; the right panel is the plot of the residual versus the covariate x

We can also compare these against the theoretical quantiles of the Normal distribution as follows:

```
arrange(res_samples, mean) %>%
  mutate(theortical_quantiles = qnorm(1:100 / (1+100))) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x=theortical_quantiles,y= mean)) +
  geom_ribbon(aes(ymin = q0.025, ymax = q0.975), fill = "grey70")+
  geom_abline(intercept = mean(res_samples$mean),
              slope = sd(res_samples$mean)) +
  geom_point() +
  labs(x = "Theoretical Quantiles (Normal)",
       y= "Sample Quantiles (Residuals)")
```



0.4.4 Posterior Predictive Checks

Now, instead of generating samples from the mean, we will account for the observational process uncertainty by:

1. Sampling $y_i^{1k} \sim \pi(y_i|\mathbf{y})\ k = 1, \dots, M;\ i = 1, \dots, 100$ using `generate()` (here we will draw $M = 500$ samples)

```
samples =  generate(fit.lm, df,
  formula = ~ {
    mu <- (beta_0 + beta_1)
    sd <- sqrt(1 / Precision_for_the_Gaussian_observations)
    rnorm(100, mean = mu, sd = sd)
  },
  n.samples = 500
)
```

2. Comparing some summaries of the simulated data with the one of the observed one

Here we compare (i) the estimated posterior densities $\widehat{\pi}^k(y|\mathbf{y})$ with the estimated data density and (ii) the samples means and 95% credible intervals against the observations.

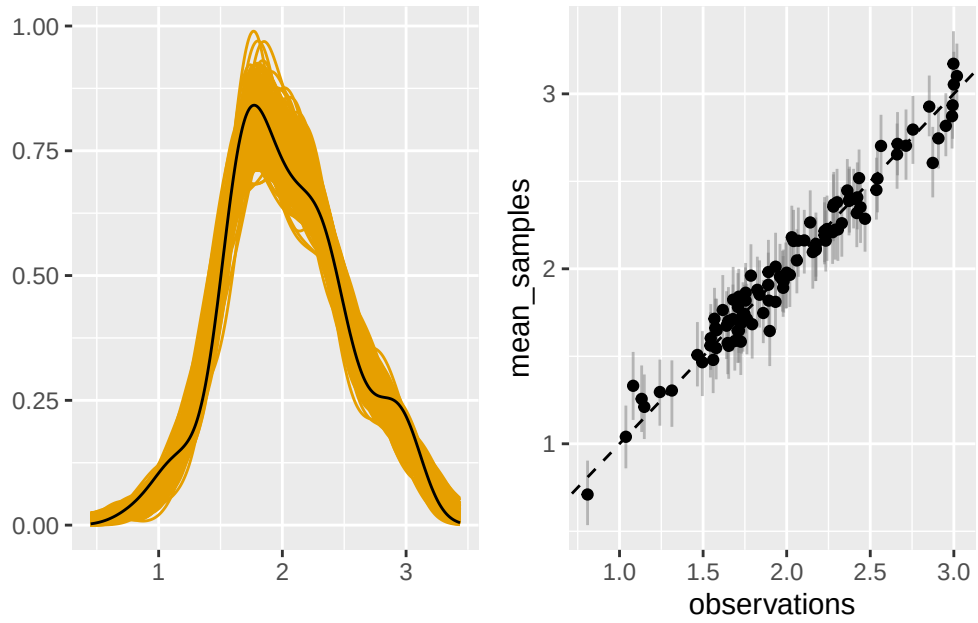
```
# Tidy format for plotting
samples_long = data.frame(samples) %>%
  mutate(id = 1:100) %>% # i-th observation
  pivot_longer(-id)

# compute the mean and quantiles for the samples
draws_summaries = data.frame(mean_samples = apply(samples,1,mean),
q25 = apply(samples,1,function(x)quantile(x,0.025)),
q975 = apply(samples,1,function(x)quantile(x,0.975)),
observations = df$y)

p1 = ggplot() + geom_density(data = samples_long,
                         aes(value, group = name),  color = "#E69F00") +
  geom_density(data = df, aes(y))  +
  xlab("") + ylab("")

p2 = ggplot(draws_summaries,aes(y=mean_samples,x=observations))+
  geom_errorbar(aes(ymin = q25,
                    ymax = q975),
                alpha = 0.5, color = "grey50")+
geom_point()+geom_abline(slope = 1,intercept = 0,lty=2)+labs()

p1 +p2
```



0 Links

- GitHub Repository
- Slides

0 License

CC-BY-4.0

0 Citation

Belmont, Martino, Illian (2026). *Spatio-temporal models with inlabru.* Noumea, New Caledonia.

0 GLM model checking

In this exercise we will:

- Learn about some model assessments techniques available in INLA
- Conduct posterior predictive model checking using CPO and PIT

Libraries to load:

```
library(dplyr)
library(INLA)
library(ggplot2)
library(patchwork)
library(inlabru)
```

In this exercise, we will use data on horseshoe crabs (*Limulus polyphemus*) where the number of satellites males surrounding a breeding female are counted along with the female's color and carapace width.

A possible model to study the factors that affect the number of satellites for female crabs is

$$y_i \sim \text{Poisson}(\mu_i), \qquad i = 1, \dots, N$$
$$\eta_i = \mu_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i + \dots$$

We can explore the conditional means and variances given the female's color:

```
crabs <- read.csv("datasets/crabs.csv")

# conditional means and variances
crabs %>%
  summarise( Mean = mean(satell ),
             Variance = var(satell),
                     .by = color)
```

```
   color     Mean  Variance
1 medium 3.294737 10.273908
2   dark 2.227273  6.737844
3  light 4.083333  9.719697
4 darker 2.045455 13.093074
```

The mean of the number of satellites vary by color which gives a good indication that color might be useful for predicting satellites numbers. However, notice that the mean is lower than its variance suggesting that overdispersion might be present and that a negative binomial model would be more appropriate for the data (we will cover this later).

Fitting the model

First, lets begin fitting the Poisson model above using the carapace's color and width as predictors. Since, color is a categorical variable in our model we need to create a dummy variable for it. We can use the `model.matrix` function to help us constructing the design matrix and then append this to our data:

```
crabs_df = model.matrix( ~  color , crabs) %>%
  as.data.frame() %>%
  select(-1) %>%         # drop intercept
  bind_cols(crabs) %>%  # append to original data
  select(-color)         # remove original color categorical variable
```

The new data set `crabs_df` contains a dummy variable for the different color categories (`dark` being the reference category). Then we can fit the model in `inlabru` as follows:

```
cmp =  ~ -1 + beta0(1) +  colordarker +
       colorlight + colormedium +
       w(weight, model = "linear")

lik =  bru_obs(formula = satell ~.,
            family = "poisson",
            data = crabs_df)

fit_pois = bru(cmp, lik)

summary(fit_pois)
```

```
inlabru version: 2.15.0
INLA version: 26.08.22
Latent components:
beta0: main = linear(1)
colordarker: main = linear(colordarker)
colorlight: main = linear(colorlight)
colormedium: main = linear(colormedium)
w: main = linear(weight)
Observation models:
  Model tag: <No tag>
    Family: 'poisson'
    Data class: 'data.frame'
    Response class: 'integer'
    Predictor: satell ~ beta0 + colordarker + colorlight + colormedium + w
    Additive/Linear/Rowwise: TRUE/TRUE/TRUE
    Used components: effect[beta0, colordarker, colorlight, colormedium, w], latent[]
Time used:
    Pre = 0.31, Running = 0.95, Post = 0.0702, Total = 1.33
Fixed effects:
              mean    sd 0.025quant 0.5quant 0.975quant   mode kld
beta0       -0.501 0.196     -0.885   -0.501     -0.117 -0.501   0
```

```
colordarker -0.008 0.180     -0.362   -0.008      0.345 -0.008   0
colorlight   0.445 0.176      0.101    0.445      0.790  0.445   0
colormedium  0.248 0.118      0.017    0.248      0.479  0.248   0
w            0.001 0.000      0.000    0.001      0.001  0.001   0

Deviance Information Criterion (DIC) ...............: 917.12
Deviance Information Criterion (DIC, saturated) ....: 561.74
Effective number of parameters .....................: 5.01

Watanabe-Akaike information criterion (WAIC) ...: 929.70
Effective number of parameters .................: 16.51

Marginal log-Likelihood:  -489.43
 is computed
Posterior summaries for the linear predictor and the fitted values are computed
(Posterior marginals needs also 'control.compute=list(return.marginals.predictor=TRUE)')
```

0.8.1 Model assessment and model choice

Now that we have fitted the model we would like to carry some model assessments. In a Bayesian setting, this is often based on posterior predictive checks. To do so, we will use the CPO and PIT - two commonly used Bayesian model assessment criteria based on the **posterior predictive distribution**.

> **Posterior predictive model checking**
>
> The posterior predictive distribution for a predicted value $\hat{y}$ is
>
> $$\pi(\hat{y}|\mathbf{y}) = \int_{\theta} \pi(\hat{y}|\theta)\pi(\theta|\mathbf{y})d\theta.$$
>
> The probability integral transform (PIT) introduced by Dawid (1984) is defined for each observation as:
>
> $$\text{PIT}_i = \pi(\hat{y}_i \leq y_i|\mathbf{y}{-}i)$$
>
> The PIT evaluates how well a model's predicted values match the observed data distribution. It is computed as the cumulative distribution function (CDF) of the observed data evaluated at each predicted value. If the model is well-calibrated, the PIT values should be *approximately uniformly distributed*. Deviations from this uniform distribution may indicate issues with model calibration or overfitting.
> Another metric we could used to asses the model fit is the conditional predictive ordinate (CPO) introduced by Pettit (1990), and defined as:
>
> $$\text{CPO}_i = \pi(y_i|\mathbf{y}{-}i)$$
>
> The CPO measures the density of the observed value of y_i when model is fit using all data but y_i. CPO provides a measure of how well the model predicts each individual observation while taking into account the rest of the data and the model. *Large values indicate a better fit* of the model to the data, while small values indicate a bad fitting of the model

To compute PIT and CPO we can either:

1. ask `inlabru` to compute them by set `options = list(control.compute = list(cpo = TRUE))` in the `bru()` function arguments.
2. set this as default in `inlabru` global option using the `bru_options_set` function.

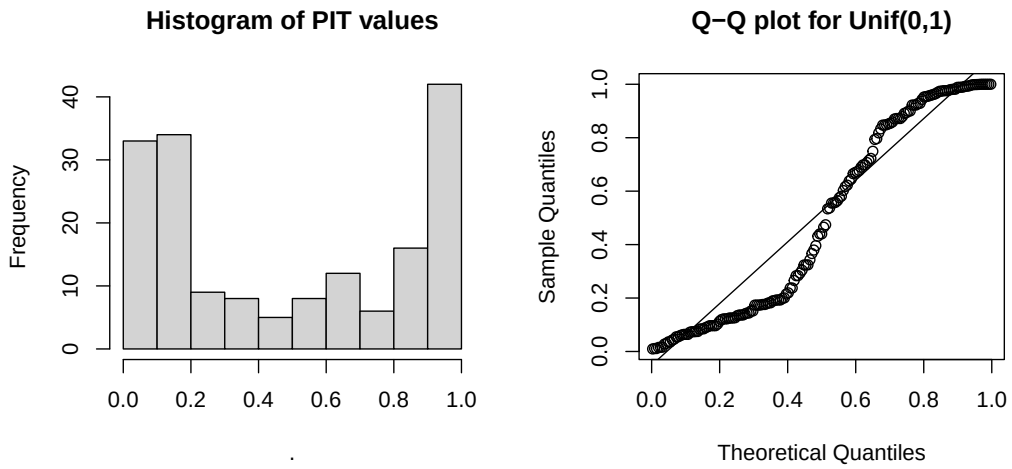
Here we will do the later and re-run the model

```
bru_options_set(control.compute = list(cpo = TRUE))

fit_pois = bru(cmp, lik)
```

Now we can produce histograms and QQ plots to assess for uniformity in the PIT values which can be accessed through `inlabru_model$cpo$pit`:

1 Plot



.

2 R Code

```
fit_pois$cpo$pit %>%
  hist(main = "Histogram of PIT values")

qqplot(qunif(ppoints(length(fit_pois$cpo$pit))),
       fit_pois$cpo$pit,
       main = "Q-Q plot for Unif(0,1)",
       xlab = "Theoretical Quantiles",
       ylab = "Sample Quantiles")

qqline(fit_pois$cpo$pit,
       distribution = function(p) qunif(p),
       prob = c(0.1, 0.9))
```

Both Q-Q plots and histogram of the PIT values suggest a not so great model fit. For the CPO values, usually the following summary of the CPO is often used:

$$-\sum_{i=1}^{n} \log(\text{CPO_}i)$$

This quantities is useful when comparing different models - a smaller values indicate a better model fit. CPO values can be accessed by typing `inlabru_model$cpo$cpo`.

Task

The model assessment above suggests that a Poisson model might not be the most appropriate model, likely due to the overdispersion we detected previously. Fit a Negative binomial to relax the Poisson model assumption that the conditional mean and variance are equal. Then, compute the CPO summary statistic and PIT QQ plot to decide which model gives the better fit.

Take hint

To specify a negative binomial model you only need to change the family distribution to `family = "nbinomial"`.

Click here to see the solution

```
par(mfrow=c(1,2))

# Fit the negative binomial model

lik_nbinom =  bru_obs(formula = satell ~.,
            family = "nbinomial",
            data = crabs_df)

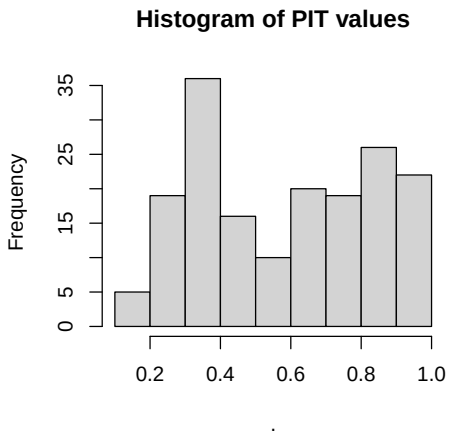
fit_nbinom = bru(cmp, lik_nbinom)

# PIT checks

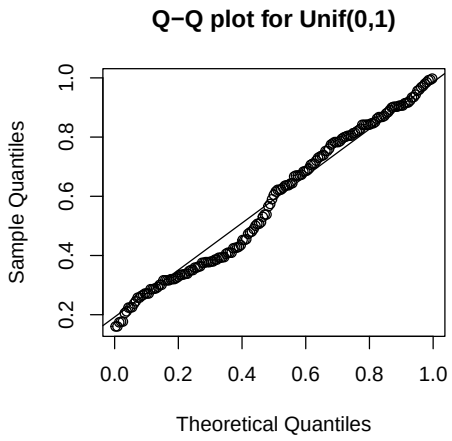
fit_nbinom$cpo$pit %>%
  hist(main = "Histogram of PIT values")

qqplot(qunif(ppoints(length(fit_nbinom$cpo$pit))),
       fit_nbinom$cpo$pit,
       main = "Q-Q plot for Unif(0,1)",
       xlab = "Theoretical Quantiles",
       ylab = "Sample Quantiles")

qqline(fit_nbinom$cpo$pit,
       distribution = function(p) qunif(p),
       prob = c(0.1, 0.9))
```



.




```
  # CPO comparison

  data.frame( CPO = c(-sum(log(fit_pois$cpo$cpo)),
                      -sum(log(fit_nbinom$cpo$cpo))),
              Model = c("Poisson","Negative Binomial"))
```

```
       CPO              Model
1 465.4057            Poisson
2 379.3329 Negative Binomial
```

```
  # Overall, we can see that the negative binomial model provides a better fit to the data.
```